

JOSH JAMES SAUNDERS



<https://joshjames.site>

Senior Infrastructure Engineer / DevOps / Cloud Platform Engineer

LinkedIn: <http://au.linkedin.com/in/joshjsaunders> | **Email:** joshsaunders@gmail.com | **Phone:** 0435 872 159

Professional Summary

Experienced Senior Infrastructure, Sysadmin, DevOps and Cloud Platform Engineer with 20+ years across infrastructure, back end software development, and operations. Proven success leading large-scale cloud and automation initiatives for enterprise and government clients.

Over a decade in enterprise ICT , Microsoft, Vmware and data-centre operations.

Expert in AWS, Azure, Kubernetes, Terraform, and CI/CD architecture. Adept at designing scalable, resilient, and secure solutions leveraging Infrastructure as Code and container orchestration. Passionate about cloud-native automation, AI-driven infrastructure management, and continuous improvement across hybrid and multi-cloud environments.

Core Skills

- Sysadmin, Infrastructure & Operations.
- Cloud Platforms: AWS, Azure, GCP, Openstack
- Infrastructure as Code: Terraform, Bicep, CloudFormation
- Containers & Orchestration: Docker, Kubernetes (EKS/AKS/GKE), Helm
- CI/CD & Automation: Jenkins, GitLab CI, GitHub Actions, AWS CodePipeline
- Scripting: PowerShell, Python, Bash, Node.js
- Networking & Security: VPC design, IAM, API security, zero-trust architecture
- Monitoring & Logging: CloudWatch, Azure Monitor, ELK, Prometheus, Grafana
- AI Data models, Machine learning (RAG, vector Db, hpc pipelines, data ingestion)
- Systems: Linux (RHEL/Ubuntu), Windows Server, Active Directory, Vmware

Compliance/Industry

- Supported APRA-regulated infrastructure and audit requirements - (NAB, RACQ Bank, ANZ, various MSP's)
- Experience operating in SOC2 enterprise environments (Fintech, Liven, Suncorp, MSP's)
- Managed secure production infrastructure for banking and insurance sectors
- ITIL / ISO/IEC 27001 / HIPAA - (Public sector roles, QLD Health, TMR)
- Implemented IAM, logging, monitoring, backup, disaster recovery, and change management controls
- Participated in security reviews, audits, compliance remediation, and operational governance processes

Professional Experience

Freelance / Contracts / Projects

Senior DevOps Engineer – Department of Communities and Housing

Nov 2024 – Aug 2025 (Contract)

Managed and optimised AWS-hosted **Kubernetes** environments supporting multiple app tiers. Implemented automated **EKS** lifecycle patching, blue-green deployments, and **CI/CD** integrations for Node.js microservices. Led secure API integration with financial institutions.

Technologies: **AWS (EKS, CDK, Terraform, IAM, VPC, S3, CloudWatch)**, **Kubernetes, Helm, Docker, CodePipeline, [Node.js](#)**

Senior Cloud Specialist – Department of Transport & Main Roads QLD

Jan 2023 – Nov 2023 (Contract)

Delivered Azure Landing Zones via Terraform modules, complete configuration management, Automated hybrid identity and multi-cloud networking with ExpressRoute and Direct Connect. Defined compliance guardrails for scalable Azure governance.

Technologies: Azure, Terraform, Azure AD/Entra, Azure DevOps, Landing Zones, AWS CloudFormation

Senior Platform Engineer – Auto & General

Nov 2023 – Nov 2024

Delivered Terraform-based IaC foundations for Azure, AWS, and GCP. Unified DevOps tooling and implemented GPU-enabled clusters for AI/ML prototyping. Streamlined multi-cloud infrastructure and improved CI/CD reliability.

Heavily customer data regulated environment requiring soc compliance, worked with Data and security teams to align with compliance and auditing outcomes.

Technologies: Terraform, puppet, Azure AKS, AWS ECS/EKS, GCP GKE, Jenkins, Azure DevOps, Identity & IAM

Permanent Positions

Cloud Operations Engineer – Ac3

2022 – 2023 - 18 months

Supported large government and enterprise clients using Terraform automation across Azure, and VMware. Integrated Terraform with CI/CD for secure, auditable infrastructure delivery.

Technologies: Azure, VMware, Jenkins, GitLab CI, ECS, RDS, Route53, Active Directory

Senior Site Reliability Engineer – Liven

2020 – 2022 - 2 years

Led AWS infrastructure transformation during rapid growth phase. Built global multi-region stack with CI/CD automation, enabling geo-based routing, database replication, and near-zero downtime deployments. Configuration management for all server deployments as code in git.

Technologies: AWS, Google Cloud, ECS, RDS, ElasticSearch, Redis, Terraform, Ansible

Earlier Experience (Summary)

- **Rackspace** – Cloud Automation Engineer (2019–2020): Automated SaaS platform transitions using Ansible Tower and Terraform.
- **ARQ Group** – Senior DevOps Engineer (2019–2020): Delivered AWS-based ML and computer vision platforms for ANZ and Dominos.
- **NAB** – Cloud Infrastructure Engineer (2019): Led Red Hat-based cloud migration initiative across 35,000+ applications.
- **RACQ Bank** – Cloud Infrastructure Consultant (2018): Improved AWS CI/CD pipelines and operational resilience.
- **Versent / CMD / Woolworths / QLD Health** (2015–2018): Multiple large-scale DevOps, cloud migration, and automation projects across AWS and Azure.

- **Prior Roles** (2004–2015):

Senior Systems Administrator – **Sundale** – 3 years

Network Engineer/Head of Infrastructure - **Lindsay Australia** – 4 years

Systems & wintel administrator – **QPAC** – 4 years

roles across enterprise and government environments, focusing on automation, virtualization, and scalable architecture as well as traditional datacentre, server, storage and networking operations.

Education

- Murdoch University – Applied Science (Mechanical & Electronic Engineering)
- Southern Cross University – Bachelor of Information Technology (Deferred)
- NSW Institute of TAFE – Diploma Systems Administration (with Distinction), Cert IV Network Management

Certifications

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect / DevOps Engineer
- Cisco Routing & Switching
- VMware vSphere 4 & 5
- Red Hat RHCE
- Microsoft MCITP / Exchange / SharePoint / SCCM

Interests

AI research, cloud automation, distributed systems, hardware design, space technology, and Science.